

the wrong size for you, BP reading will be incorrect. Measure around your upper arm at the midpoint between your shoulder and elbow, and choose your cuff size from the chart given in the table.

Cuff inflation. Recent devices come with a feature where once the cuff is wrapped around the arm, it inflates automatically. But there are devices for which you have to inflate the cuff manually. For users who have to measure BP themselves, automatic inflation is a preferable choice.

Irregular heartbeat monitor. Many BP monitors can also detect irregular heartbeat while calculating BP and send alerts regarding those to the users.

Memory. Larger the memory, more readings can be stored in the device. This is an important feature for those who need to regularly review the history of BP readings, while consulting with their doctors.

Multi-user capability. Some machines have the capability of storing readings for more than one user. This is an extremely useful feature for households where more than one individual needs to record BP readings.

Body-movement detection. This feature allows the device to detect body movement and, more importantly, adjust the readings accordingly. It is expected to make the readings more accurate.

Sphygmomanometer display. Some devices display traditional BP measurements by displaying a sphygmomanometer-like bar, which is useful for traditional doctors who like to get a feel of the old time.

Some popular brands available in India

- Citizen
- Dr Morepen
- Omron
- Panasonic
- Rossmax

UPPER-ARM BP MONITOR CUFF SIZES

Measurement (cm)	Cuff size
18-22	Small
22-32	Medium
32-45	Large

Most home BP monitors come with a medium-size cuff; you may need to order a different-size one separately

Batteries. BP-measurement devices are typically battery-powered. However, some have rechargeable batteries. In terms of convenience and long-term cost-benefits, you may want a model with rechargeable batteries.

LCD display size. All brochures list this feature. Though not a critical one, it is obvious—the larger the display, the better and bigger is the information displayed.

Weight. This is an important feature for those who carry their BP device with them wherever they go.

What next

Some of the latest BP devices being launched are harnessing the power of mobile devices. These come bundled with apps, which get downloaded on the mobile device.

The devices focus on measuring BP and transmitting data to the mobile device. Their apps use the power of the mobile device to display the information and provide interesting reports and analytics.

Then there are products that focus on better-designed cuffs to reduce errors because of their incorrect placement of cuffs.

However, this product category now faces competition in the form of wearable devices. Latest health-focused wearable devices include smartwatches that have BP monitors. While these do not offer accuracy comparable to a standard BP device, as of now, it is to be seen how their growing popularity may affect demand for traditional BP-monitoring devices. **EFY**

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Website: www.shavison.com
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SHAVISON ELECTRONICS PVT. LTD.
 Unit No. G-5, B Wing, Udyog Bhavan No. 2, Plot K-3,
 Anand Nagar MIDC, Ambarnath (E) 421 506, MH, India.
 Tele/Fax: +91-251-2620417/ 2620427 Cell: +91 98 203 62980
 Ahmedabad: Integrated - 0825709665 Anchari: Kalspesh - 9322215500 Ankleshwar / Bharuch: Mahanshi - 08679061845
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